

SNCB Case

Situation

It was a Thursday afternoon in June 2017 and Jai, a Principal Product Manager with GlobalTravel (GT), had just gotten off his monthly call with the SNCB Team. What the SNCB team communicated to him on the call had him worried.

SNCB operates the rail network in Belgium, Netherlands & Luxembourg (BeNeLux). They had an API based platform which GT had integrated with. SNCB was planning to upgrade their APIs in Jan 2018 and if GT didn't upgrade to the latest APIs by Dec 2018, GT would lose access to the SNCB content.

GT had 2 multi-national customers in BeNeLux – AB Consulting (ABC) and EM Energy (EME). While the business from BeNeLux for these 2 customers was not large, ABC and EME were 2 of GT's top 5 customers globally.

His gut feel was that this upgrade would be expensive. His plan was to launch UK Rail in 2018, something he had promised the UK team in 2016. An expensive SNCB upgrade in 2018 would mean that he would need to postpone the UK Rail work to 2019.

GlobalTravel Company Background

GlobalTravel (GT) is a corporate travel booking tool used by ~70% of the Fortune 200 in the US market. GT was launched in 1997 in the early days of the internet.

Once a corporation signs up with GT:

- Their travel managers can set up their travel policies (for example eligibility for business class travel based on flight duration/ designation)
- Their employees get access to GT
- Employees can search for and book their own travel – air/ rail/ hotel/ rental car
- Travel self-service saves the corporation about \$7.50 per booking

Jai as a Principal Product Manager with GT is responsible for the Hotel and Rail portfolios. Jai has been with GT since Dec 2013.

GT European Operations Background

GT had expanded into Europe in 2012 as one of their largest customers in the US, AB Consulting, wanted their European operations also to be serviced by GT. As part of this, GT

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had integrated with various rail operators in Europe such as SNCF (France) and SNCB (BeNeLux) in early 2013.

The key customers using Belgium rail are AB Consulting and EM Energy. GT had invested over \$300k for the integration 2013. The revenue from Belgium Rail is \$40k per year.

Relevant GT Organization

Name/ Role/ Location	Notes
Jai - Principal PM Bangalore	Product Manager responsible for Rail & Hotel. He has been with GT since Dec 2013. He is personally committed to delivering UK rail in 2018, since its been a gap in the rail portfolio since 2014.
Mark - Sr Principal Architect Dallas	Mark is responsible for the Rail architecture. He has been with GT since 2005 and is extremely passionate and knowledgeable. His estimate for the SNCB upgrade work is about \$300k and a timeline of 6 months. In the past, his estimates have tended to be less than the actual effort.
Deepa - Tech Lead Bangalore	Works closely with Mark for Rail implementations. She joined GT in Dec 2016. She is super excited about working on parts of the product which are new to her.
Anne - Director PM Dallas	Responsible for GT product Management. She joined GT in Jan 2016. Jai reports to Anne. She doesn't like to get involved in day-to-day activities but expects to be pulled in wherever required. She has a good relationship with Denise, the Director for Customer Success (see below). Given her English origins, Anne has a keen interest in the UK market.
Maurizio - Customer Success Manager Brussels	Maurizio joined GT in 2014. He is responsible for the BeNeLux business of AB Consulting & EM Energy. Maurizio is extremely concerned about keeping the 2 customers happy since there are no other customers in BeNeLux.

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Name/ Role/ Location	Notes
Kyle - Customer Success Manager San Francisco	While she is responsible for the global business of AB Consulting & EM Energy, she is primarily focussed on the US business. 2 of her key priorities for 2018 – Retain the BeNeLux business of ABC and EME and increase their business in the UK.
Denise - Director Customer Success New York	Responsible for Customer Success globally. She has been with GT since 2005. Maurizio & Kyle report to Denise. She doesn't like to get involved in the day-to-day operations and likes to leave that to her team. Denise is really looking forward to the UK rail delivery in 2018 so that she can onboard the UK business of some of the large US multinational customers. But she hates losing existing business more than she hates losing out on new business opportunities.
Richard - Director – New Business Development UK London	Richard has been with GT since 2014. He has had limited success in generating new business in the UK. He has very vocally attributed the lack of new business in the UK to the lack of UK Rail. He is frustrated with the product team for not getting UK Rail till 2018.
Greg - General Manager GT Dallas	Responsible for the GT P&L. He has been with GT since Jan 2013. He has 2 key revenue priorities: - Retain and grow existing customers globally - Acquire new customers globally Richard, Anne & Denise report to Greg. Greg and Richard had worked together in their previous organization. Greg had recruited Richard in 2014.

Discussion Questions

1. Who is the key decision maker in this situation?
2. Who are the influencers in this situation?
3. Is this an example of needing to be Agile (respond to change)?
4. Create a stakeholder map for this situation using the interest vs influence matrix.
5. Create a Persona analysis for Maurizio, Anne, Richard, & Greg